CONTENT STRATEGY / DECISION MEMO

OTT streaming catalogue

Three evidence-led opportunities for content strategy

TO	DATE	DATASET
Content Strategy / Acquisition Team	**12 October 2026**	**Netflix catalogue snapshot**
FROM	**STATUS**	**COVERAGE**
Prasanna Shetty	Working draft — validate before decisions	5,850 titles • 1945–2022

EXECUTIVE VIEW

The catalogue metadata suggests three practical follow-ups: compare the rating profile of shows and movies without treating ratings as viewing performance; use popularity and ratings as separate signals when building title shortlists; and close the certification-label gap before relying on suitability mix for portfolio decisions.

5,850	+0.7	63.1%
Titles in snapshot	**Median score gap**	**Movie labels missing**
3,744 movies • 2,106 shows	Shows vs movies; titles with ≥100 votes	vs 12.1% for shows

THREE ACTIONABLE INSIGHTS

01	Format ratings differ. Eligible shows have a 7.10 median IMDb score vs 6.40 for movies. Test by genre/region and validate against internal viewing signals.
02	Popularity is not the same as rating. IMDb and TMDb scores are moderately aligned (ρ=0.63), while TMDb popularity and IMDb score are weakly related (ρ=0.09).
03	Certification metadata is uneven. The certification label is missing for 63.1% of movies vs 12.1% of shows; clean this before using certification mix in decisions.

DECISION REQUESTED

Approve the next step — not a greenlight decision

Authorize a focused validation sprint:
(1) build a shortlist using rating + popularity signals,
(2) audit missing certification labels, and
(3) validate candidates against internal watch time, completion, retention, regional demand and cost data.

Scope guardrail: the supplied file is a Netflix catalogue snapshot only. IMDb scores, IMDb votes and TMDb popularity are third-party metadata—not Netflix viewing, completion, retention, acquisition-cost or ROI measures. This memo does not compare Netflix with Prime Video or Hotstar.

INSIGHT 01 / FORMAT & RATING PROFILE

Shows score higher in the rated subset

Working finding • Eligible shows have a median IMDb score of 7.10, compared with 6.40 for movies — a 0.70-point difference.

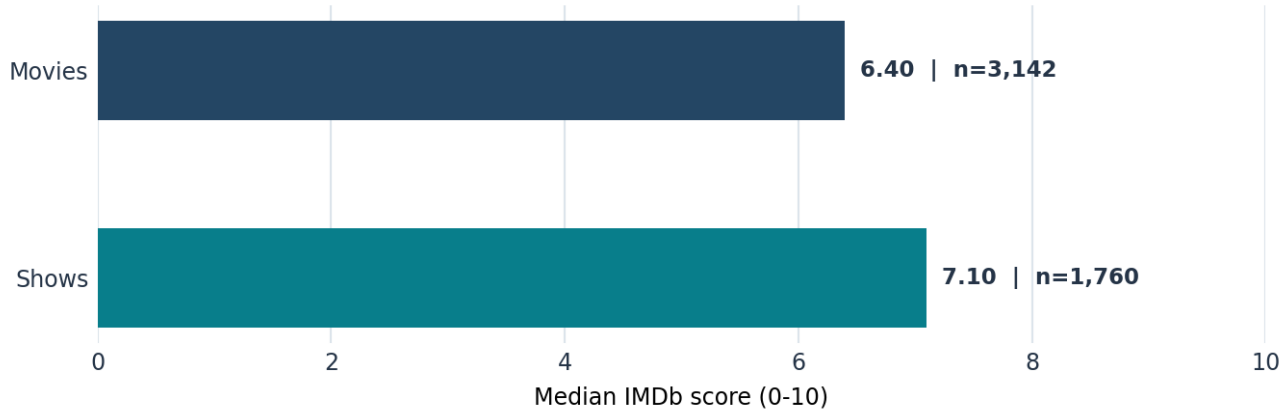


Figure 1. Median IMDb score among titles with IMDb score present and at least 100 IMDb votes. n denotes qualifying titles.

EVIDENCE AT A GLANCE

MOVIE MEDIAN	SHOW MEDIAN	DIFFERENCE
6.40 n = 3,142	7.10 n = 1,760	+0.70 Shows minus movies

What this means

- **Signal:** within the rated subset, shows have a higher typical IMDb score than movies.
- **Limit:** this is third-party rating metadata, not evidence that shows generate more viewing hours, retention or revenue.
- **Decision use:** treat the score gap as a hypothesis for deeper genre-, region- and cost-level analysis — not as a reason to automatically favour shows.

Recommended action

Build a format-aware content shortlist

Compare the highest-rated available shows and movies within genre, production region, release period and runtime bands. Add internal completion rate, hours watched, returning-viewer rate, licensing cost and rights availability before ranking candidates.

TEST / OWNER	SUCCESS METRIC
[Define genre/region cuts and shortlist owner]	*[e.g., shortlist hit-rate against internal watch-time / completion]*
TIMEFRAME	**DECISION RULE**
[Start date] → [Review date]	*[What evidence would justify a change in acquisition focus?]*

INSIGHT 02 / DISCOVERY SIGNALS

Popularity and rating answer different questions

Working finding • IMDb and TMDb scores show a moderate positive association, but TMDb popularity has only a weak association with IMDb score in this snapshot.

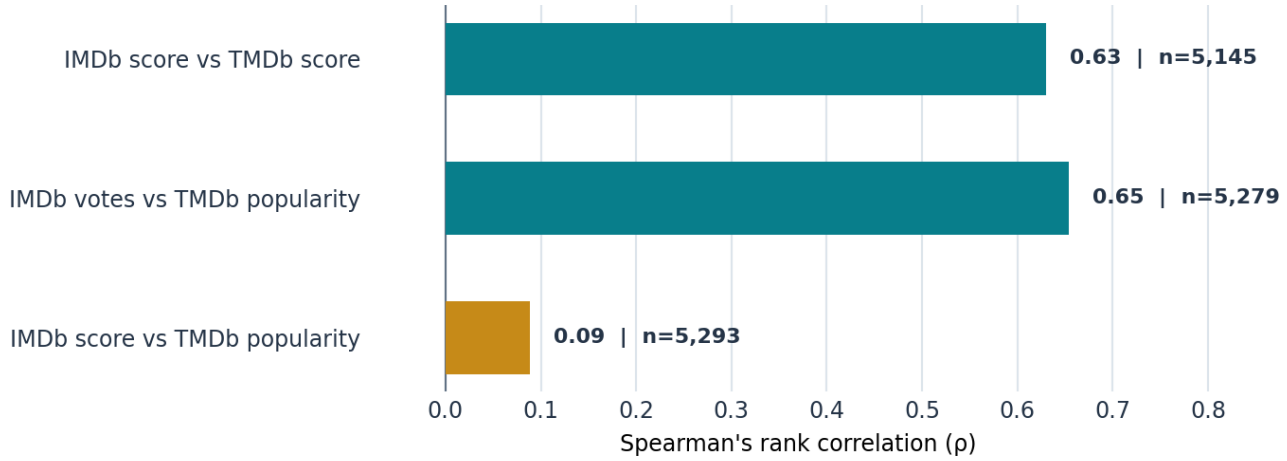


Figure 2. Spearman rank correlations computed on pairwise complete observations. Association is not causation.

How to read the signals

RATING AGREEMENT

ρ = 0.63

n = 5,145
Use both scores as supporting evidence, not interchangeable truth.

POPULARITY ≠ SCORE

ρ = 0.09

n = 5,293
A popularity rank alone does not identify highly rated titles.

ATTENTION SIGNALS

ρ = 0.65

n = 5,279
Votes and TMDb popularity tend to rise together.

Recommended action

Create a two-signal discovery shortlist

Use a simple matrix: (1) high rating + high popularity = proven candidates to benchmark; (2) high rating + lower popularity = discovery candidates; (3) high popularity + lower rating = investigate audience interest versus satisfaction; (4) low on both = lower priority unless strategically differentiated.

Make the recommendation testable

01 SHORTLIST	Set explicit score/popularity thresholds and minimum vote support. Document how titles with very few votes are treated.
02 VALIDATE	Join approved internal performance data: impressions, starts, completion, hours watched, repeat viewing, retention and cost.
03 DECIDE	Compare shortlisted titles with a baseline or matched titles; keep, revise or reject the hypothesis based on a defined evaluation window.

FILL IN BEFORE PRESENTING

INSIGHT 03 / METADATA READINESS

Certification labels are much less complete for movies

Working finding • The age_certification field is missing for 63.1% of movies (2,364 of 3,744) versus 12.1% of shows (255 of 2,106).

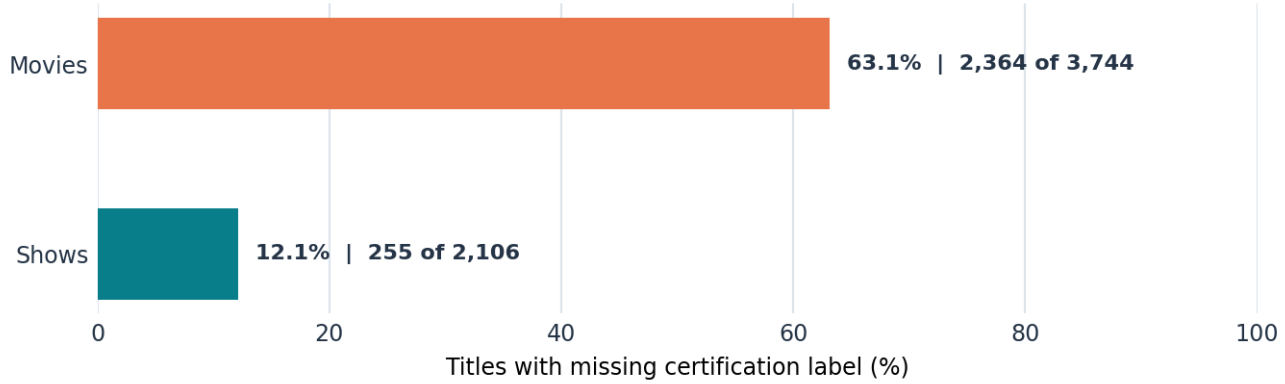


Figure 3. Missing or blank labels in the supplied age_certification column. Missing does not mean uncertified.

Recommended action

Treat certification coverage as a data-quality workstream

Create a title-level backfill queue, prioritise records used in upcoming editorial or acquisition decisions, and record the source and verification date for every correction. Preserve the original country/system label; store any analytical suitability band in a separate, documented field.

30-day execution plan

WEEK 1	Confirm decision question, owner and minimum evidence needed.	Owner: Prasanna Shetty
WEEK 2	Audit missing certification labels and document approved sources / mapping rules.	Owner: Prasanna Shetty
WEEK 3	Build and review candidate shortlist with genre, region, score and popularity cuts.	Owner:Prasanna Shetty
WEEK 4	Validate against internal performance and cost data; present recommendation and caveats.	Owner: [name]

Measurement and decision guardrails

DATA QUALITY	CONTENT TEST
[Target missing-label rate] • [Coverage check] • [Verified-source rate]	*[View / completion / retention KPI] • [Cost guardrail] • [Test window]*

Method note: Dataset has 5,850 unique title records and release years 1945–2022. Rating comparison uses titles with imdb_votes ≥100 and a non-null imdb_score. Correlations use pairwise complete rows. Certification figures count null or blank age_certification values. These findings describe catalogue metadata; validate business impact with platform-owned viewing, retention, territory, rights and cost measures before making acquisition or commissioning decisions.